

USSR.

The family moved to Moscow in 1948. Schnittke studied composition at the Moscow Conservatory, and completed his postgraduate studies in 1961. That year, he married the pianist Irina Kataieva, and took up a teaching post at the Moscow Conservatory. His early compositions were in the mold of Dmitri Shostakovich, who dominated the Soviet music scene, but through the 1960s he began to explore Modernist techniques in his work, including the serialism of Schoenberg and Webern.



**GIDON KREMER**

Gidon Kremer, seen here with his chamber orchestra, the Kremerata Baltica, in 2002, performed Schnittke's work and was influential in raising his profile.

## Prolific creativity

Unhappy with both the conventional, Soviet-approved model and much of the avant-garde, Schnittke developed a way of creating a synthesis of these, along with other styles of classical and even